

CINEBENCH 2003

The results from this benchmark are quite interesting: CINEBENCH 2003 makes perfect use of Intel's HyperThreading technology, and hence we see Intel's 3.2 GHz processors taking the steam out of AMD's processors and coming out on top. Except for the Celeron D, nearly all Intel processors performed extremely well here.

To clarify, HyperThreading does not involve two physical processors. It is accomplished by having a virtual processor along with the physical one. The results of this test are important for the future: both Intel and AMD are due to release dual-core CPUs-processors with two physical cores on a

an application makes use of these streaming instructions. The DivX codec has been optimised for Intel processors, and so you see the boost when you use Pentium 4 processors.

The lower-clocked Sempron 2400+ and 2500+ paid the penalty, taking the last slots, falling behind the slightly higher-clocked Celeron D processor.

DOOM 3

In the gaming test too, AMD's processors took the crown; interestingly, it was the Athlon 64 2800+. The Athlon64 3000+ was behind the 2800+ by 3 fps. Close on its heels were its cost-effective siblings, the Sempron 3000+ and 3100+.

The Intel processors were completely overshadowed by the startling performance of the Athlon 64 range. In fact, the new Sempron 3100+, 3000+ and 2800+, which cost no more than Rs 6,000, performed better than Intel's expensive Pentium 4 series. The scores returned by the Celeron D 2.53 GHz processor were

pathetic—just about half of what the Athlon 64 2800+ returned.

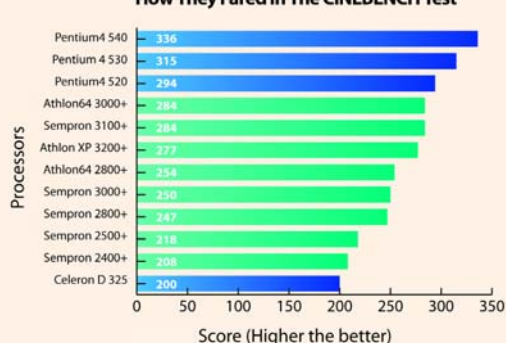
Another point to remember is that DOOM 3 is more graphically intensive than Half-Life2—future games using this engine will rely more on your graphics card than on the CPU.

Half-Life 2

The results obtained from this test are interesting because the scores scale with rated processor performance. Intel's 3.2 GHz Pentium 4 managed to steal the limelight thanks to its higher clock speed and larger cache. However, the Athlon 64 3000+ was a hair's breadth away from the leader, which is commendable, taking into account the 1.2 GHz speed advantage the P4 enjoys over the 3000+.

The competition really heated up for third place between the Athlon 64 2800+ and the Pentium 4 3 GHz. Eventually, the AMD topped the Intel processor by a small margin. With the help of faster clock speeds, the Pentium 4s—the 3 and 2.8 GHz—beat the lower-clocked Semprons. From the

How They Fared In The CINEBENCH Test



single die—in the latter half of this year. If the current breed of HT-enabled processors derive a good performance benefit, it would be interesting to see the performance of dual-cores on this benchmark and similar multi-threaded applications.

dBpowerAMP

The Athlon 64 3000+ was the fastest at ripping songs from a CD, getting the job done in just 77 seconds. Surprisingly, the Sempron 2800+ took second position, displacing the Athlon64 2800+ to third position. Intel's P4 3.2 GHz was outgunned even by the Sempron 3100+. The Celeron processor was nearly 31 per cent slower than the Athlon64 3000+.

DVD to DivX

In DivX encoding, the tides favour Intel. Both the Pentium 4s—the 3.2 and 3 GHz—beat the Athlon 64 3000+ by a considerable margin. The results clearly indicate that DivX encoding relies heavily on core clock speeds, streaming instructions (SSE, SSE2, SSE3), and how well



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